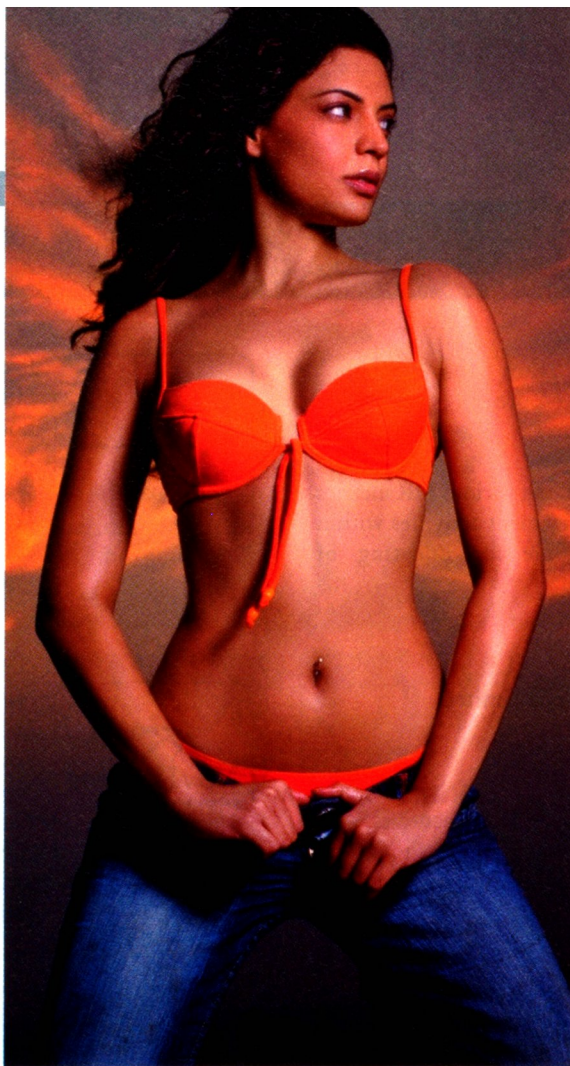


CHOP STORY

Sandhya Shetty, 30, is a sultry stunner at first glance but she also packs in plenty of brawn. The model recently picked up the bronze in the 23rd Senior National Karate Championship despite a serious ankle injury. Shetty also has a stack of gold medals lining her shelf, two of them from the Maharashtra karate state championships. Now the feisty wannabe actor is preparing to represent India at the Asian Games in China this November. "A designer friend got me into karate six years ago and I've loved every minute of it," she says. But the former Miss India finalist isn't about to give up on her modelling career just yet. Nor has she stopped scouting for films. Is Akshay Kumar paying attention?



PRAVIN TALAN

Role Play

This leggy model is legging it to France. **Shweta Bhardwaj** is donning a whopping 72 roles in a French film tentatively titled *I Can't Change The World Alone*. Her look will range from an African tribal to a Japanese, but juggling different roles shouldn't be a problem. After all, this showstopper for Leocanet Hemant at the recent fashion week has already had a stint in Bollywood. She is even shaking a leg with Shiamak Davar's troupe in the US. As long as Bollywood doesn't forget what she looks like.



Yesterday Once More

History is being repeated after five decades at the behest of the Shiv Sena. **Lata Mangeshkar** will sing *Priya aamcha Maharashtra desh ha* (our beloved Maharashtra) to mark the golden jubilee of Maharashtra Day on May 1. She last sang the song for Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru on the same day 50 years ago when Maharashtra attained statehood. "I will be very happy if the audience sings with me." For once, the Sena is doing something worthwhile.

BHASKAR PAUL/www.indiatodayimages.com



Twice as Cute

Two is better than one. Especially when it comes in a package as cute as the five-year-old twins **Zaynah** and **Ziyah Vastani**. While Zaynah plays the title role in the TV show *Apki Antara*, twin sister Ziyah is set to take on Bollywood with the Priyadarshan-directed *Bum Bum Bole*. "After Ziyah got the movie role, Zaynah wanted to act in TV. They like to do the same thing at the same time," says mother Havov.

